

GovRisk Capability Statement for the ISF ICE Team
Focus: Latin America
March 2025

Synopsis of GovRisk's services and experience:

GovRisk is an independent UK-based consultancy with a niche focus and global reach. We provide specialist expertise to positively impact the rule of law and the rules-based international system. We support countries around the world with advice and capacity building to facilitate positive reform, support implementation, strengthen enforcement, and reduce impunity.

Our clients include sovereign governments, international bodies, multilateral organisations, non-governmental organisations (NGOs), communities, sports organisations, the private sector, as well as civil society and educational institutions.

Our projects tackle the obstacles to sustainable development and good governance, such as corruption and financial crime.

Over the past 12 years we have successfully delivered over 100 projects across 55 countries and 5 continents. We have established ourselves as a leading provider of justice reform, anti-corruption, financial crime, and integrity expertise.

Thematic Areas

GovRisk offers research, training, and consulting expertise across a wide range of technical areas within the sphere of financial crime, integrity, governance, and transparency. This includes:

Financial Crime Prevention

Technical assistance and advisory support on all aspects of financial crime prevention, detection, investigation, and prosecution, including preparation and follow-up for relevant international assessments (e.g. FATF Mutual Evaluations).

Anti-Corruption

Capacity-building and technical assistance to support anti-corruption efforts from legal reform and prevention initiatives through to prosecution.

Public Financial Management And Accountability

Programmes and initiatives supporting the increased efficiency, transparency, and accountability of public entities' expenditure, policies, and programmes. This includes public procurement digitalisation and legislative reform.

Improving The Business Environment

Promoting improved regulation of the business environment, corporate compliance, and accountability, and fostering dialogue and effective partnerships between public policy-makers and the private sector.

Judicial Reform

Promoting the improved efficiency of judicial processes and procedures in line with international best practice.

Relevant project work LatAm

Provide below is a reverse-chronological record of GovRisk's projects in Latin America. Each entry specifies its date range or year(s), along with the original description of objectives, activities, and outcomes. Arranged from the most recent to the earliest, these projects highlight GovRisk's role in tackling corruption, advancing financial crime prevention, and promoting transparency and good governance throughout the region. For details on GovRisk's initiatives outside Latin America, please contact us.

1. 2024/26: Enhancing the professionalization and intelligence capabilities of personnel combating Money Laundering Operations in Mexican States

As a key subcontractor to the Pan American Development Foundation (PADF), GovRisk is leading the implementation of the INL/PECEL project in Mexico, which aims to enhance the professionalization and intelligence capabilities of personnel combating Money Laundering Operations. Collaborating closely with institutions across eight target states, including Economic and Asset Intelligence Units and State Financial Intelligence Units (UIPEs), along with Public Prosecutor's Offices, GovRisk focuses on strengthening their capacities to identify, investigate, and combat illicit financial activities. A comprehensive diagnostic assessment is currently underway to ensure a targeted approach in effectively analyzing and prosecuting Money Laundering crimes. Based on this assessment, GovRisk will recommend and support changes to the legal, regulatory, and constitutional frameworks. The initiative includes developing standardized processes and activities for all UIPEs and designing a training curriculum tailored to the Mexican context. The training modules will cater to various actors involved in critical investigations and criminal procedures. Through strategic interventions, GovRisk is deploying diverse tools, methodologies, training sessions, events, and simulated trials to enhance the skills of all stakeholders tackling complex Money Laundering cases. Additionally, GovRisk is collaborating with national platforms such as the National Commission for Oversight and Anti-Corruption to promote best practices endorsed by the project.

2) 2023/24: Tackling Illicit Financial Flows (Colombia, Ecuador, Peru and Panama)

GovRisk is the subcontractor to DAI Global UK in the delivery of the Strategic Institutional Support to Tackle Illicit Financial Flows in Latin America Program, which is part of the Conflict Stability and Security Fund funded by the UK's Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO). The program aims to strengthen intra-regional collaboration between Financial Investigation Units (FIUs) to share best practices between countries, particularly focusing on strengthening the strategy and response of countries in the region in the fight against Illicit Financial Flows and corruption. GovRisk is subcontracted by DAI to develop the 2024 Guide for Joint Strategic and Operational Analysis between UIFs under the Tackling Illicit Financial Flows in Latin America (TIFF) project, supported by the UK FCDO through the Integrated Security Fund (ISF). This initiative enhances the capacity of Financial Intelligence Units (FIUs) in Latin America to conduct joint investigations into money laundering (ML) and terrorism financing (FT). GovRisk collaborates with FIUs from Colombia, Ecuador, Panama, and Peru, through bilateral exchanges, multilateral visits, and workshops focused on sharing best practices. The guide aims to provide a structured framework for FIUs to streamline joint investigations, improve operational capabilities, and enhance cooperation across national and regional authorities. It includes sections on intelligence investigations, strategic and operational analysis, and coordination, aligned with global standards like the Financial Action Task Force (FATF)

and the Egmont Group. To ensure successful implementation, GovRisk proposes capacity-building initiatives such as tailored training workshops, on-site consultations, and technology support. Regional activities, including workshops, joint simulation exercises, and the creation of a regional network, will further strengthen collaboration and trust among participating FIUs, boosting efforts to combat illicit financial flows across Latin America.

3) 2021–2024: Countering the Financing of Terrorism in South America (Argentina, Brazil & Paraguay)

GovRisk is a key subcontractor to the American Bar Association in the delivery of this multiyear U.S. Department of State funded project designed to build the capacity of governments and financial sector stakeholders in Argentina, Brazil, and Paraguay and the Tri-Border Area to degrade and disrupt the financing of Hizballah and other terrorist groups, thus limiting their ability to plan and carry out attacks in the TBA region and globally. The program aims to strengthen the effective implementation of anti-money laundering and countering the financing of terrorism (AML/CFT) measures in a manner consistent with the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) recommendations. GovRisk is responsible for:

1. assessing opportunities to strengthen public and private sector institutions' capacity to effectively combat money laundering (ML) and terrorist financing (TF);
2. increasing key AML/CFT actors' understanding of best practices and the reforms required to optimize their respective AML/CFT regimes; and
3. co-developing action plans for reform for key program beneficiaries. The program will support the implementation of these action plans through targeted technical assistance designed to increase local institutional capacity to regulate, supervise, identify, report, investigate and prosecute money-laundering and terrorist financing, as well as to strengthen targeted financial sanctions. The program will also promote enhanced regional collaboration to combat ML and TF in the TBA.

4) 2021/22: Strategy and Capacity Building for the adoption of improved models for the criminal investigation of embezzlement and homicides in Mexico

GovRisk was the key implementer of this UK Foreign Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO) funded project, which aimed to support public prosecutors in Mexico City, Tabasco, Jalisco, and Chihuahua in adopting improved standards and processes for investigating homicides and embezzlement. This initiative built upon the UK Government's previous Anti-Corruption and Rule of Law (ACROL) programming in Mexico, which had been canceled in 2021 due to COVID-19 and corresponding cuts to UK ODA funding. The project ensured the effective uptake of the clearer and more consistent investigative processes and standards developed under ACROL. Specialized training programs were scaled up, equipping officials with the necessary skills to conduct effective investigations through real-case scenarios. The initiative also integrated new technologies, including digital records and data-driven decision-making tools. Beyond capacity building, the programme strengthened interagency coordination by fostering collaboration between prosecutors, forensic experts, and law enforcement agencies. It supported the implementation of standardized forensic and case management procedures to enhance investigative efficiency and transparency. By reinforcing investigative capabilities and institutional coordination, the project improved prosecution outcomes for homicide and embezzlement cases. It also facilitated knowledge exchange with UK experts, promoting best practices and innovative methodologies to enhance accountability and public trust in Mexico's justice system.

5) 2020–2025: Transparency and Accountability in Public Investment in Peru

GovRisk is a key subcontractor to Chemonics in the delivery of this five-year programme which launched in 2020. Funded by the United States Agency for International Development (USAID), it is designed to develop integrity standards to be applied by regional governments delivering public works, which will be monitored by integrity networks made up of civil society and private sector representatives. GovRisk is responsible for the delivery of activities designed to contribute to strengthening prevention, control, and supervision mechanisms to reduce corruption at the regional and national level. This includes supporting the following: the application and monitoring of an Integrity Index; the development of an effective methodology for detecting and managing corruption risk and integrity gaps; the application of Simultaneous Control in prioritised investment projects; the implementation of an improved risk management methodology; the application of the Integrity Standards; and the development of an online corruption reporting system for citizens.

6) 2019/20: Monitoring of the Business Integrity Initiative (BII) Pilot Activities in Mexico

The Business Integrity Initiative (BII) Pilot Activities in Mexico were successfully monitored and evaluated by GovRisk, an independent UK organization specializing in financial crime prevention and capacity-building. The BII-Mex pilot ran from July 2019 to August 2020 and involved four projects implemented by local and international organizations. These projects aimed to improve regulations, build SME capacity to navigate corruption risks, standardize business requirements, and raise awareness of business integrity principles and practices. GovRisk assessed the pilot's effectiveness in attracting diverse participants, its impact on business policies, and its value for money. Through surveys, interviews, and field observations, the evaluation examined engagement levels and satisfaction while real-time feedback mechanisms allowed for continuous improvements. Thematic case studies provided deeper insights into integrity challenges, helping refine approaches to supporting businesses. Regular monitoring ensured that strategic recommendations were made to optimize future initiatives. Findings were shared with stakeholders, including UK government agencies and Mexican partners, contributing to broader learning on business integrity. The final report highlighted key successes, lessons learned, and sustainability strategies, supporting ethical business practices in Mexico. These insights also informed regional discussions, exploring opportunities for replication in Latin America.

7) 2018/21: UK Prosperity Fund's 2018 Anti-Corruption and Rule of Law (ACROL) Programme in Mexico

GovRisk was a key subcontractor to PA Consulting in the delivery of this multiyear UK FCDO Prosperity Fund's 2018 Anti-Corruption and Rule of Law (ACROL) Programme in Mexico. The project supported Mexico's efforts to improve public services by enhancing processes and building capacity within key government agencies responsible for detecting and investigating serious crime and corruption. By strengthening institutional frameworks and coordination mechanisms, the project aimed to foster an equitable, sustainable, and democratic society while driving inclusive economic growth. A strong emphasis was placed on addressing homicide, embezzlement, and cybercrime. Through targeted interventions, the project established clearer and more consistent investigative processes and standards. It increased accountability in public services by streamlining and standardizing procedures, including national and subnational guidelines for evidence gathering, forensic practices, and data reporting. Specialized training programs were scaled up to equip officials with the necessary skills to conduct effective investigations, using real-case scenarios and integrating new technologies such as

digital records and data-driven decision-making tools. Efforts to improve interagency coordination resulted in the development of guidelines and working groups that enhanced collaboration among anti-corruption and Rule of Law institutions at federal, state, and municipal levels. These mechanisms facilitated better information sharing and strengthened civil society's role in holding the government accountable. The project's outcomes included the adoption of improved investigative processes, enhanced capacity among officials, and stronger coordination among key stakeholders. By focusing on homicide, embezzlement, and cybercrime, the project contributed to a more effective criminal justice system and a more transparent business environment in Mexico. Lessons learned were shared to support future reforms and encourage the replication of successful strategies beyond the project's timeframe.

8) 2018/19: Scoping Study on Serious Organised Crime in Panama, Including Financial Crime, with a Particular Focus on Money Laundering, Corruption, and Narcotics

The UK Government was developing its 5-year strategy relating to Serious and Organised Crime (SOC) in Panama and shaping its priorities for upcoming CSSF Fund projects. To support this, GovRisk was contracted to conduct an in-depth scoping study to offer evidence-based analysis and recommendations. The Scoping Study analyzed the threats in place and weaknesses in Panama's institutions and approach. It assessed the strengths in the work being done so far and identified gaps where specific and targeted interventions from the British Government (including through locally implemented CSSF projects) could have the biggest impact in tackling SOC, in line with the British government '4 P's' approach. It also offered highly targeted recommendations developed by a team of leading international experts, including a roadmap identifying priority action points. The study helped inform further UK investment in combating SOC in Panama and was submitted in March 2019.

9) 2017/18: (Multiple Projects for This Period)

(a) Introducing Best Practices into the Legislative and Operational Design for the Execution of Joint Anti-Money Laundering Investigations by Competent Authorities in Guatemala, Honduras, and El Salvador

To support the improved delivery of international investigations by the competent authorities in Guatemala, Honduras, and El Salvador, and contribute to wider efforts to prevent the proceeds of crime and funds supporting terrorism from entering the countries' financial systems, the programme aimed to introduce UK and international best practices into the legislative and operational design of Joint Anti-Money Laundering Investigations Teams. Project impacts meant that key officials responsible for developing the legislative framework and operational design for executing Joint Anti-Money Laundering Investigation Teams were better placed to incorporate international best practices as they advanced this agenda in the Northern Triangle. This included increased capacity, political will, and informal networks for information exchange between individuals and institutions in each of the three jurisdictions.

(b) Promoting Efficiency, Transparency, and Accountability in Framework Agreements in Panama, with a Particular Focus on Government Procurement of Heavy Construction Machinery

Technical assistance was provided to Panama's General Directorate of Public Contracts (DGCP) to design and begin implementing a new and improved Framework Agreement for public procurement of heavy construction machinery, aimed at increasing efficiency, transparency, and accountability. The

programme facilitated the introduction of UK and other international best practices into the restructuring process of the Administrative and Operative departments of the DGCP, which establishes, supervises, and monitors Framework Agreements. This included addressing a number of weaknesses that were identified in the existing structure, as required to increase efficiency. This project was delivered in collaboration with Panama's General Directorate of Public Contracts and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(c) Compliance with the New Institutional Responsibilities of the New National Anti-Corruption System: Strategy and Capacity Development for the Attorney General's Office of Mexico

The project ensured that the Specialized Anti-Corruption Unit of the Attorney General's Office adopted UK and international intelligence, investigation, and communication best practices into its strategy and methodology for investigating crimes committed by public servants against the administration of justice. This included refining its approach to coordination with the administrative units and decentralized bodies of the institution. The Specialized Unit was recently formed, and its professionalism and success in investigations are vital to the overall success of Mexico's National Anti-Corruption System (SNA). The project focused on key topics such as promoting integrity in public service by integrating innovative international practices, implementing UK best practices for intelligence in investigating and prosecuting corruption cases, developing investigation strategies for such cases, and fostering international cooperation in corruption investigations and prosecutions. Through this initiative, the Unit's technical capacity was strengthened to ensure it could fulfill its expanded responsibilities within the new framework of the SNA. The project aimed to equip the Unit to detect and respond effectively to corruption and other illicit activities, supporting investigations and contributing to successful prosecutions. By integrating international best practices into their strategy, the Unit's operational efficiency was improved, supporting the overall success of the National Anti-Corruption System and helping enhance public trust in Mexico's efforts to combat corruption.

(d) UK Prosperity Fund's Promoting Transparency of Final Beneficial Ownership Information Programme in Mexico

The project was delivered in collaboration with Mexico's Secretary of Public Administration. The project assisted Mexico in initiating actions related to beneficial ownership by conducting a comprehensive diagnostic to understand the current situation within the Federal Public Administration. The objective was to assess conceptual, regulatory, identification, information-sharing, technological, and inter-institutional coordination challenges in order to propose a roadmap for progress, including roles and responsibilities for competent stakeholders. GovRisk conducted a needs analysis consultation with the local steering committee to identify deficiencies and training needs regarding beneficial ownership. A training session was delivered for representatives of the competent authorities in Mexico, focusing on the topic of Final Beneficial Ownership. The project involved both national and international experts, as well as representatives from relevant institutions with jurisdiction over the topic. The first step was a technical workshop designed to foster dialogue among Mexican authorities and identify actions that could be taken to address the issue.

(e) UK Prosperity Fund's Incorporating International Best Practices in the Design of Anti-Bribery Protocols in Mexico

The project facilitated the analysis and incorporation of international best practices into the design of the Anti-Bribery Protocol in Mexico. Through a three-day seminar, international experts and Mexican authorities exchanged knowledge on the prevention, detection, investigation, and sanctioning of

international bribery. The event allowed participants to identify effective methodologies in intelligence, conciliation, case resolution, legal strategy, and international cooperation. Dialogue between key institutions of the National Anti-Corruption System was promoted, strengthening interinstitutional coordination. As a result, Mexican authorities gained deeper insights into successful strategies applied in other countries and reflected on their potential integration into the protocol. Each participating institution provided written feedback on the best practices discussed and their applicability in Mexico. The gathered information will serve as the foundation for the interinstitutional working group responsible for drafting and implementing the Anti-Bribery Protocol. The project marked a milestone by laying the groundwork for a stronger legal framework, aligned with international standards. International experts from the UK, Brazil, the US, France, and Argentina contributed their experience in combating corruption, ensuring a comprehensive approach tailored to the Mexican context.

(f) Strategy and Capacity Building for Improving Whistleblowing Systems and Establishing Regulations for the Protection of Whistleblowers in Costa Rica (2017–2018)

At the request of the Ministry of Justice and Peace in Costa Rica, GovRisk designed a programme to build capacity and political will to create a new whistleblowing reporting unit. This new unit was intended to allow immediate, timely, and effective responses to acts of corruption, as well as effectively protect whistleblowers, safeguarding their integrity, names, and employment status when dealing with individuals, as well as the legitimate interests of legal persons, when they sought to report acts of extortion or requests for bribery by corrupt officials. Following the delivery of key project activities, GovRisk's expert submitted recommendations to participant authorities (Office of the Minister of Justice), outlining targeted initiatives that senior officials indicated they would seek to implement. The initiatives put forward were derived directly from discussions with the Minister of Justice post-event. This key impact meant that officials responsible for developing an effective strategy and increasing capacity and political will to improve existing whistleblower systems and design new whistleblower protection legislation were better placed to incorporate international best practices as they advanced this agenda.

(g) Strategy and Capacity Building: Reducing Opportunities for Corruption in the Contracting of Public Works in Uruguay (2017–2018)

GovRisk conducted an analysis of existing vulnerabilities to fraud, corruption, and collusion in the procurement of public works in Uruguay, both at the normative and procedural levels. This was followed by a series of high-level capacity-building seminars attended by key public, private, and civil society representatives with responsibilities for the procurement and/or control of public works and infrastructure. The workshops included presentations and in-depth discussions leading to the establishment of a strategic action plan, including concrete actions to address the identified risks. This project was delivered in collaboration with Uruguay's Transparency and Public Ethics Commission (JUTEP) and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(h) Justice Management Reform Model: Better Public Efficiency and Reduced Corruption (Brazil, 2016–2017) [Listed under some 2017/18 references]

To increase efficiency and performance in the judiciary system management model and foster better justice services in Brazil to implement corruption-fighting mechanisms, GovRisk was invited by the Prosecutor General of the Republic (PGR) to share best UK and international practices. As a result of the programme, an improved and unique lawsuit workflow management model was created using

international benchmarks, which provided a solution for the problem of poor performance in some courts. By having this new methodology mapped, analyzed, designed, and implemented, the courts were able to deliver faster judgments and rulings, decreasing the burden on the system and opening space for the adoption of new corruption-fighting tools. Following the programme, which took place in both the UK and Brazil, senior members of the PGR proposed several internal measures to improve the performance of the PGR. To organize these measures, an action plan was created, pledging key actions to be undertaken because of the project.

10) 2016/17: (Multiple Projects for This Period)

(a) Strategy and Capacity Building in Paraguay for the Supervision, Monitoring and Regulation of Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs) for Compliance with AML/CFT

The overall objective of this project was to ensure that the proceeds of crime and funds in support of terrorism are prevented from entering the financial and other sectors in Paraguay, or are detected and reported by these sectors by ensuring that supervisors appropriately supervise, monitor and regulate Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs) for compliance with AML/CFT requirements commensurate with their risks. Project impacts meant that key stakeholders from Paraguay's competent authorities for AML/CFT are now collectively better placed to incorporate best practices to ensure the effective regulation and supervision of DNFBPs in accordance with their level of risk.

(b) Strategy and Capacity Building in Paraguay: Tackling Money Laundering through Criminal Cross-border Transportation of Cash and Bearer Negotiable Instruments

GovRisk implemented this programme to assist the Secretariat for the Prevention of Money Laundering of Paraguay (SEPRELAD) in the incorporation of international best practice into its strategy, processes, and procedures for the tackling of money laundering through criminal cross-border transportation, thus enhancing their capacity to detect, prevent and manage money laundering cases.

(c) Strategy and capacity building in Guatemala for the Supervision, Monitoring and Regulation of Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs) for Compliance with AML/CFT

The overall objective of this project was to ensure that the proceeds of crime and funds in support of terrorism are prevented from entering the financial and other sectors in Guatemala, or are detected and reported by these sectors, by ensuring that supervisors appropriately supervise, monitor and regulate Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs) for compliance with AML/CFT requirements commensurate with their risks. Project impacts meant that key stakeholders from Guatemala's competent authorities for AML/CFT are now collectively better placed to incorporate best practices to ensure the effective regulation and supervision of DNFBPs in accordance with their level of risk.

(d) Justice Management Reform Model: Better public efficiency and reduced corruption in Brazil

In order to increase efficiency and performance in the judiciary system management model and foster better justice services in Brazil to implement corruption-fighting mechanisms, GovRisk was invited by

the Prosecutor General of the Republic (PGR) to share best UK and international practice. As a result of the programme an improved and unique lawsuit workflow management model was created using international benchmarks which provided a great solution for the problem of poor performance in some courts. By having this new methodology mapped, analysed, designed and implemented, the courts were able to deliver faster judgments and rulings, decreasing the burden in the system and opening space for the adoption of new corruption-fighting targeted tools. Following the programme, which took place in both the UK and Brazil, senior members of the PGR proposed several internal measures to improve the performance of the PGR. To organise these measures, an action plan was created, pledging key actions to be undertaken as a result of the project.

(e) Support for Cuba in its Implementation of its AML/CFT Strategy for Supervising, Regulating and Monitoring Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs) – Phase IV

GovRisk leveraged its high level of experience in the field of financial crime to support the Cuban government in detecting and preventing the entrance of criminal and terrorist funds into the country's financial system. GovRisk achieved this by ensuring competent authorities were able to appropriately identify, assess, and take effective action in mitigating money laundering by Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBP's), in accordance with their level of risk.

(f) Strategy and Capacity Building for Quality Control of the Audits of Mexico's Supreme Federal Audit Institution (ASF) and the Implementation of a Communication Strategy that Strengthens the Impact of the Audit Reports issued by the ASF on the Measures Adopted by Congress and its Committees

The programme supported the ASF (Federal Audit Office of Mexico) in implementing initiatives to improve its operations, focusing on integrating international best practices into its Quality Control System and establishing standards for a future independent Audit Quality Control Unit. GovRisk's support included a series of workshops identifying and promoting the uptake of these best practices, ensuring alignment with global standards. These interventions were necessary in light of the establishment of secondary legislation that introduced changes to the ASF's functions, operations, and faculties within Mexico's new National Anti-Corruption System (NAS). The project aimed to enhance the technical capacity of key governmental institutions within the NAS to fulfill their expanded responsibilities and amended mandates.

Two key areas were addressed. First, in Audit Quality Control, the programme strengthened mechanisms to maintain the credibility and effectiveness of Mexico's Supreme Audit Institution (SAI). While Mexico's framework was aligned with INTOSAI standards, the ASF's expanded reporting requirements posed new challenges. The programme emphasized leadership, ethical requirements, human resources, and engagement performance as crucial components of an effective quality control system. Second, the programme improved the ASF's Reporting and Communications with Congress. Previous reports were too technical, limiting their impact. The programme worked to enhance clarity, timeliness, and accessibility, ensuring that audit findings better informed legislative decision-making and budgeting processes, ultimately reinforcing the ASF's role in promoting transparency and accountability.

(g) Strategy and Capacity Building for the development of new best practice whistleblower system for public servants in Mexico

The programme supported the Secretary of Public Administration (SFP) in establishing and beginning to implement a new best practice whistleblower system for public servants, as well as civil society.

This initiative was crucial to enable the SFP to effectively detect and respond to suspicious behavior, wrongdoing, and violations of the law, including acts of corruption by federal public servants. In light of the changes introduced by the secondary legislation within Mexico's new National Anti-Corruption System (NAS), the project focused on enhancing the technical capacity of the SFP to fulfill its expanded responsibilities and amended mandates. The intervention addressed several key areas: a) mechanisms to sensitize the public and generate confidence in the whistleblower system; b) providing accessible platforms for reporting; c) managing whistleblower complaints; d) proactive trend analysis based on the data generated from the system; and e) establishing regulations for whistleblower protection. These elements were necessary to ensure the SFP's ability to effectively respond to complaints, prevent corruption, and support investigations and prosecutions. An effective whistleblower system is vital for detecting corruption and supporting the successful prosecution of those involved. The programme strengthened the SFP's role in fostering transparency and accountability, contributing to the long-term success of the National Anti-Corruption System and improving public trust in the government.

(h) Leveraging UK Best Practices to Support the Design of Panama's New Anti Corruption Legislation

The Panamanian government requested assistance from the UK Embassy to draft new anti-corruption legislation that would leverage UK Best practices. The UK Embassy in Panama contacted GovRisk to support the organisation of two events and facilitate the participation of a suitable expert that would review the draft legislation and provide and defend targeted recommendations for improvement, with a particular focus on anti-bribery and conflict of interests. GovRisk organised a small workshop/round table to discuss specific recommendations on the draft legislation with public officials responsible for its development and a public presentation of the theory/best practice that informs good legislation, with an audience of MPs from the National Assembly.

11) 2015/16: (Multiple Projects for This Period)

(a) Strategy and Capacity Building for the Effective Implementation of Mexico's New National Anti- Corruption System

GovRisk's intervention, funded by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office (FCO), significantly contributed to the development of Mexico's National Anti-Corruption System (NAS). GovRisk facilitated consensus-building among the key institutions involved in the NAS, ensuring that international best practices and the specific needs of Mexico's anti-corruption bodies were reflected in the secondary legislation. Through a series of targeted activities, GovRisk focused on two main issues: ensuring transparent and effective coordination among institutions, and clearly defining the roles of key agencies in corruption prevention, administrative accountability, and the criminal process. By engaging directly with Mexican Senators, Congress members, and technical teams, GovRisk helped raise and address crucial concerns that could affect the system's effectiveness. These discussions directly informed the design of the secondary legislation, ensuring it aligned with the operational realities of Mexico's anti-corruption framework. As a result, GovRisk's activities played a key role in shaping a legislative structure that would promote coordination, collaboration, and efficiency among the various institutions, strengthening the overall integrity of the NAS. This intervention not only supported the formalization of the reforms but also contributed to the long-term effectiveness of the National Anti-Corruption System.

(b) Strategy and Capacity Building in Cuba for the Supervision, Monitoring and Regulation of Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs) for Compliance with AML/CFT – Phase III (Cuba, 2015-16)

This tailored training programme assisted Cuba's competent authorities to structure and implement an efficient system of regulation, inspections, surveillance, prevention and rectification for all Designated Nonfinancial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs), in accordance with international best practice.

(c) Strategy and Capacity Building for the Supervision, Monitoring and Regulation of Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs) in Uruguay for Compliance with AML/CFT

GovRisk implemented a technical assistance programme to train both regulated entities and Uruguay's competent authorities to appropriately supervise, monitor and regulate Designated Non-Financial Businesses or Professions (DNFBPs) for compliance with AML/CFT requirements commensurate with their risks.

(d) Enabling Measurable Performance Improvements for Burma's Financial Intelligence Unit (FIU) and Regulated Sectors Towards the Country's Financial Action Task Force (FATF) Mutual Evaluation

The programme was designed to assist Burma's Financial Intelligence Unit to implement the "receive, analyse, disseminate" portion of the 2014 AML Law by improving practical knowledge of tactical and strategic analysis in an exchange programme with Indonesia's FIU, PPATK.

(e) Building Capacity in Competition Enforcement Methods for Competition Authorities in Latin America

This programme's main goal was to strengthen the institutional capacity of regional competition authorities to ensure more efficient enforcement of existing powers when conducting cartel investigations. Key areas of assistance included: implementing successful leniency policies; investigation powers/tools available to competition authorities; investigation procedures; and collecting, handling, and using evidence. Assistance was provided by the GovRisk faculty, guest experts including the OECD, as well as leading investigators from participating regional competition authorities. This project was delivered in collaboration with Panama's Competition Authority and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(f) Transparency and Accountability: Introducing International Best Practices in Panama's Procurement Framework

Technical assistance was provided to the interinstitutional commission responsible for reforming Procurement Law 22 to facilitate the adoption and adaptation of international best practices relating to: A) the implementation of transparent, non-discriminatory, and predictable public procurement processes; and B) reducing bureaucratic procurement procedures, thereby relieving the burden on international businesses competing for tenders for public contracts. Following the assistance, several revision meetings took place before the new Law was sustained before the Cabinet and presented to the National Assembly in February 2016. This project was delivered in collaboration with Panama's General Directorate of Public Contracts and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(g) Strategy and Capacity Building for the Effective Implementation of Colombia's New Anti-Bribery Legislation (2015-2016)

Assistance was provided to Colombia's Superintendence of Companies and its Transparency Secretariat to bridge critical knowledge and skill gaps and establish internal and external policies and procedures that reflect international best practices and will allow them to conduct successful investigations against companies that commit bribery in international business transactions. Its objective was to ensure that Colombia's new Anti-Bribery Law would be implemented effectively, with improved detection, investigation, sanctioning, and prevention strategies, methodologies, and technologies, based on the UK Bribery Act as a best practice reference. As a result of this project, Colombia's new anti-bribery legislation incorporated provisions similar to the internationally recognized standards of the UK Bribery Act and helped introduce reforms to improve compliance by the private sector with its requirements. This project was delivered in collaboration with Colombia's Superintendence of Companies and its Transparency Secretariat and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

12) 2014/15: (Multiple Projects for This Period)

(a) Implementing Best Practice Anti-Bribery Policies In Peru (2014/15)

A series of bespoke seminars and a targeted communications campaign were delivered to reduce resistance from the Peruvian business community, the press and congressional representatives, to proposed legislation establishing direct corporate liability for bribery cases in Peru, as required for the ratification of the OECD Anti-Bribery Convention. Assistance was provided by the GovRisk faculty, guest experts including the OECD, as well as by the Director of Peru's High-Level Anti Corruption Commission (HLACC). This project was delivered in collaboration with Peru's HLACC and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(b) Suspicious Transaction Report (STR) Analysis and Designated Non-Financial Business and Professions (DNFBPs) Regulation in Burma and Indonesia

This project provided a database for Burma's Financial Intelligence Unit to receive and analyse STRs, created bespoke to the FIU's data and requirements. It consulted with new reporting sectors (DNFBPs) covered by the country's 2014 AML Law, who are required to submit STRs for the first time. Finally, it coordinated an analyst exchange with Indonesia's FIU (PPATK), working with both countries on the enhancement of analysis techniques and developing recommendations to plan the strategy for organisational development of an FIU.

(c) The Judicial Approach to Money Laundering, Corruption and Asset Recovery in Papua New Guinea (PNG)

GovRisk implemented a tactical, high-level capacity building programme which supported the Judiciary's capacity to handle cases that relate to Money Laundering, Corruption, Restraint, Confiscation, Asset Recovery and Mutual Legal Assistance.

(d) Simplification, Transparency, and Efficiency: Introducing Best Practices in Procurement Processes for Public Works in Panama

GovRisk assisted the Ministry of Public Works with: A) the simplification and streamlining of Panama's procurement processes for public works, including improved internal coordination, internal information management and tracking, and the removal or reduction of unnecessary regulations and procedures which constituted barriers to greater participation of national and international bidders; and B) the development and implementation of an internal referential pricing database through which information on the costs paid for all goods and services is recorded and can be consulted in real time. This project was delivered in collaboration with Panama's Ministry of Public Works and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(e) Promoting Transparency and Good Governance in Latin America's Infrastructure Investment Public Procurement Programme (2014-2015)

GovRisk provided strategic capacity building to policy formulators and senior managers of key stakeholders in Colombia, Chile, Costa Rica, Mexico, Panama, and Peru to facilitate the implementation of targeted reforms to infrastructure procurement policies and processes, in line with UK and OECD best practices. Key areas of assistance included: identifying risks and vulnerabilities; typologies of corruption and fraud; fighting collusive practices in the tendering process; the High-Level Reporting Mechanism (HLRM), its implementation in Colombia, and overcoming the practical and legal obstacles for the implementation of HLRMs throughout the region; advanced techniques for infrastructure project oversight and lessons learned from Business Driven Collective Action Initiatives. On completion, all programme delegates submitted plans on how they would reform infrastructure procurement policies and procedures as a result of their participation in the programme. Assistance was provided by the GovRisk faculty, guest experts including the OECD and Basle Institute on Governance, as well as experts from beneficiary institutions. This project was delivered in collaboration with Colombia's Transparency Secretariat and its National Infrastructure Agency and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(f) Strategy and capacity building in Mexico for the Supervision, Monitoring and Regulation of Traditional and Non-Traditional Financial Institutions for Compliance with AML/CFT

This project supported Mexico's National Banking and Securities Commission (CNBV) which is responsible for supervising compliance policies and obligations, as detailed in the National Banking and Securities Commission Law and in the Federal Law for the Prevention and Detection of Transactions Involving Illicit Resources, for all financial institutions under its remit. It is responsible for monitoring the implementation of the above and has the power to sanction non-compliant entities. Reforms to the General Law on Auxiliary Credit Organisations and Activities issued in 2011 brought a new series of financial sector activities—particularly those relating to Multiple Purpose Financial Institutions (SOFOMES), money remitters and currency exchange centres—under the regulatory remit of the CNBV. Such amendments dramatically increased both the scale and scope of the activities which the CNBV needed to undertake in the area of AML/CFT, moving from regulating 310 to over 6,000 institutions. The project activities helped ensure that Mexico's competent authorities appropriately supervise, monitor and regulate Traditional and Non-Traditional Financial Institutions for compliance with AML/CFT requirements commensurate with their risks, preventing proceeds of crime and terrorism funds from entering the financial sector.

13) 2013/15: Preparing Cuba for the Revised Financial Action Task Force Mutual Evaluation (Cuba, 2013–2014)

Under this three-year programme, GovRisk experts assisted competent government authorities in Cuba to achieve a fair FATF country Evaluation and to implement the resulting reforms to its AML/CFT regime. The Mutual Evaluation Report (MER) for Cuba was published in July 2015. The results were highly positive and the Evaluation commended Cuba's efforts and reported that the country 'has updated and strengthened its AML/CFT framework, largely in line with FATF standards'. This progress is particularly noteworthy given that Cuba was on the FATF 'blacklist' only as recently as February 2013.

14) 2013/14: (Multiple Projects for This Period)

(a) Manual Design and Capacity Building for Peru's Comptroller General's Office: Identifying and Investigating Fraud, Corruption and Waste in the Procurement of Public Works

Technical assistance was provided to Peru's Comptroller General's Office for the development of an official institutional manual providing practical instruction for officials at national, regional and local levels to identify and address the corruption risks involved in the procurement of public works. This includes advanced tools based on international best practice to identify, investigate and prosecute misconduct in each stage of the procurement cycle. This project was delivered in collaboration with Peru's Comptroller General's Office and Peru's High Level Anti Corruption Commission and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(b) Capacity Building for Major Construction Firms Operating in Peru: Identifying and Investigating Fraud, Corruption and Waste in the Procurement of Public Works

Technical assistance was provided to Major Construction Firms Operating in Peru on how to identify and address the corruption risks involved in the procurement of public works. This project was delivered in collaboration with the Lima Chamber of Commerce and Peru's High Level Anti Corruption Commission and was co-financed by the participating construction firms and the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(c) Confiscation, Seizure and Forfeiture of Illegally Acquired Assets in Belize

(2013/14) More details are available on request.

(d) Capacity Building for Peru's Public Prosecutor's Office: Identifying, Investigating & Prosecuting Fraud & Corruption in Public Procurement

(2012/13 or 2013/14 references) Capacity building for approximately 100 senior anti-corruption prosecutors, assistant senior prosecutors, provincial prosecutors and their deputies from 24 regional Departments in advanced techniques for the investigation and prosecution of procurement fraud. This project was delivered in collaboration with the Peru's Public Prosecutor's Office and Peru's High Level Anti Corruption Commission and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

15) 2012/13: (Multiple Projects for This Period)

(a) Public Procurement in Colombia: Strategy and Training (2012–2013)

Assistance was provided to help increase the efficiency, competitiveness, and transparency of public procurement processes in Colombia via the centralization of Colombia's procurement function. 25 key policy formulators and procurement officials in charge of the procurement process (representing the National Agency of Procurement, General Controller Office, Attorney General Office, as well as INVIAS, ICBF, Ministry of Defence, and SENA) were provided strategy and capacity building. Senior officials from Colombia Compra Eficiente (CCE) – the project's main beneficiary (and newly established at the time) – reported that the project had directly informed numerous areas of policy and significantly advanced the development of its e-procurement platform. The project further spurred new initiatives to centralize purchases of insurance and fuel, increase its market research function, and advance its e-procurement platform. Furthermore, the various GovRisk activities helped bring about a noticeable improvement in relations between procurement officials and members of the CCE and improved local buy-in to the procurement centralization project. Together, these enabled the advance of several new initiatives, including the creation of a network of procurement officials and a CCE-led mentoring programme for other public bodies. This project was delivered in collaboration with Colombia's National Procurement Agency (CCE) and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(b) Implementing a High-Level Reporting Mechanism (HLRM) for Accusations of Corruption and Bribery in Colombia (2012–2013)

Assistance was provided in the design and implementation plan of an HLRM for allegations of corruption (an OECD-backed initiative). Colombia's proposed framework for an HLRM was significantly strengthened as a direct result of this programme. New elements were incorporated, including a system to increase protection for those reporting bribery solicitations, better procedures for monitoring and tracking cases, and greater efforts to develop a coordinated approach to investigations. The project also triggered substantial incremental action, in the form of new guidelines for commercial organizations on how to manage and minimize corruption risks. Subsequent to this programme, Colombia successfully passed the first stage evaluation for the OECD convention and had its proposal for the HLRM approved by the organization's experts. This project made a tangible contribution to both these successes. This project was delivered in collaboration with Colombia's Transparency Secretariat and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(c) Ratification and Implementation of the OECD Anti-Bribery Convention (2012–2013)

Assistance was provided for key policy formulators, decision-makers, and senior practitioners from a wide variety of government institutions at the forefront of Colombia's anti-bribery efforts. Under the project, comprehensive mentoring and capacity building were provided to officials at key junctures in Colombia's move to ratify the OECD Convention on Combating Bribery of Foreign Officials. The success of this programme was demonstrated by the fact that Colombia passed key stages of assessment for this initiative shortly after the project. In December 2012, OECD assessors approved Colombia to pass to the second stage of the convention accession evaluation. Building on this impetus, Colombia was able to successfully ratify the OECD Anti-bribery Convention, doing so on January 19th, 2013. Colombian officials were even praised in the OECD's evaluation report for their "high level of co-operation and openness," which had allowed for "a comprehensive and effective basis" for the assessment. This project was delivered in collaboration with Colombia's Transparency Secretariat and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(d) Tackling Corruption and Collusion in Public Procurement, Latin America and the Caribbean (2012/13)

Technical assistance was provided to Latin American governments to help: A) Identify, analyse & review existing standards, processes, guidelines and/or policies in order to identify areas for improvements; b) Conduct comparative research to identify opportunities to draw on national/international best practices to make improvements; c) Help generate consensus among competent stakeholders about which national/international best practices should be adapted/adopted in beneficiary countries. A broad range of institutions involved in the anti-corruption and anti-collusion effort in 26 countries participated in this programme, as well as more than 15 international experts. Accordingly, the range of impacts and outcomes of this programme were similarly diverse. Broadly speaking, however, the changes to policies and procedures which were implemented as a result of this programme fall into the following categories: A) reforms to investigative techniques B) revision of best practice manuals C) influencing and proposing regulatory reforms, and D) spurring new policy initiatives. This project was delivered in collaboration with Panama's General Directorate of Public Contracts and was financed by the UK Foreign and Commonwealth Office.

(e) Caribbean and Latin America Forum on Financial Crime Prevention Effective Implementation of the new FATF Standards (Panama, 2012/13)

GovRisk was hired by the British Embassy in Panama to organise a regional training programme for key stakeholders with a role in implementing the revised FATF recommendations. GovRisk organised a forum attended by approximately 180 officials from a wide variety of public and private sector bodies from 25 countries. Delegates included public prosecutors specialising in money laundering and organised crime, officials from the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime financial service commissions, regulatory bodies, police, customs and excise, auditor generals, embassy representatives, financial intelligence units (FIUs), and a whole host of Panamanian and other Latin American government ministers. The consultations with local stakeholders conducted by GovRisk revealed shortcomings in the capacity of Panamanian officials, and those within the wider region, to comply with FATF international standards and, crucially, the failure of preventative measures to adequately address all the risks highlighted by FATF.

16) 2011/12: Ensuring Effective Prosecutions for Money Laundering Cases in Belize

More details are available on request. Technical assistance was provided to strengthen Belize's capacity to prosecute money laundering, focusing on investigation and evidence-handling best practices.